

FINAL REFLECTION REPORT

The final reflection report is a 1,250 word paper assignment. The assignment is to be completed individually.

For the final reflection report you are asked to synthesize relevant lessons that you want to retain from the course. That is, the final reflection report is meant to provide you with an opportunity to draw practical insights from your in-class negotiations, the class discussions, and readings. The report should be built around two components, (1) Analysis – the deduction of insights based on your class experience – and (2) Action – the development of a systematic approach to impact future behavior and decision making as a means to benefit from the identified insights.

Your preparation worksheets, post-negotiation feedback and individual written reflections all contribute data from your daily negotiation experiences. It is the integration of selected data with relevant course concepts from the readings and class meetings that constitutes a successful analysis (as opposed to mere description). However, analysis alone is not sufficient. In order for your analysis to be beneficial for changing your behavior, you should include consideration of the action steps you should take in the future. As an example, this might include thinking about some of the following questions:

- How might you overcome specific barriers to reaching a good agreement?
- What steps could you take to better anticipate and manage certain counterparty behaviors in the future?
- Through what actions would you avoid and/or utilize a common negotiation bias?
- In what situations or with what type of counterparty might a particular strategy be more or less successful?

Your final reflection report is limited to 1,250 words (about 5 pages). Please be sure to print your word count at the end of your paper. In addition, you may attach appendices for background information, summary tables, worksheets, data, etc., at the end of your text. These documents are not included in the 1,250 word count. Be sure to place all descriptive background and context information in the appendix. The body of the text should be devoted to analytical insights and action implications informed by course concepts.

Keep in mind that it is much harder to write a good 5-page paper than a 20-page paper and that it may take several tries before you settle on an approach that works for this particular assignment. As with all assignments, the final reflection report will be treated as a confidential communication. It will be returned to you, along with feedback and your course grade.

Reports are evaluated in terms of their **depth of analysis and insight together with the development of action implications**. Better reports will be more *specific* (vs. general), *deeper* (vs. broader) and *more prescriptive* (vs. descriptive). Your report should build on or extend the lessons and concepts learned in class and covered in the readings; it should demonstrate your analytical and psychological sophistication.

Submission:

Submit your final report via the course CANVAS site.

Include a cover page stating that you adhered to the Booth honor code in preparing the assignment.

Due Date: Wednesday, July 10, 2024

Additional Tips for your Final Reflection Report

Your report should:

- Concentrate on selected course concepts. Few well-developed arguments are superior to many shallow arguments.
- Be based on your experiences in the class negotiations
- Involve both analysis and action
- Be prescriptive rather than descriptive
- Be concise and pithy: use those 1,250 words with care!
- Include all supplemental material in an appendix.

Your reports should NOT:

- Be simply a story or a description
- Be solely a summary or overview of readings or concepts
- Be a blow-by-blow account of a negotiation
- Be a list of bullet-points, such as “do’s” and “don’t’s”

Focus on depth of analysis and insight:

Start by identifying an issue, a personal characteristic, tendency, reaction or behavior as the topic of your report. This issue should originate from some insight that you gained during the course of this class. Be certain that you provide an in-depth analysis of this observation, rather than a simple description of it. Some questions that you may consider addressing in this analysis include: How does this behavior/issue/tendency/etc. relate to material covered in the course readings and lectures? Where do you think this behavior/feeling/default emerges from? How did this issue influence your negotiation experience and/or outcomes? How might you evaluate this tendency/tactic/behavior that you have observed yourself engaging in or that you received feedback about? How might this tendency/issue impact a real-world negotiation that you are facing in the future?

Action Plan:

Link your analysis to a personal action plan in which you propose specific action implications. That is, an important aspect of your reflection report should be a detailed plan for changing your future behavior in order to improve your negotiation skills and experiences. When defining your action plan, be explicit about how you will plan to take specific actions towards your goals of becoming a better negotiator, based upon your analysis. Identify concrete steps that you think can help you accomplish your personal goals for improving your negotiation experiences and outcomes, and explain why you feel they will do so. If you have an upcoming real-life negotiation to which you want to apply this action plan, it may be helpful to ground your plan for future action in such an example.